



lift.md

Brand Book — v3.0 · barbell # mark

Your workouts, kept in plain text.

LIFT.MD · LIFTMARK · LIFTMARK FORMAT · MAY 2026

What's inside

[01](#) Brand at a glance

[02](#) Voice & tone

[03](#) Logo system

[03b](#) Names & sub-brands

[04](#) Clear space & sizing

[05](#) Logo misuse

[06](#) Color — brand & gradient

[07](#) Color — full scales

[08](#) Color — themes & access.

[09](#) Typography

[10](#) Iconography

[11](#) UI & components

[12](#) The format as brand

[13](#) Social & app icon

[14](#) Developer tokens

LiftMark

LiftMark turns strength training into something you can read, write, and own — plain-text workouts in a simple markdown format, tracked in a fast native app, generatable by any LLM.

The two things we are

LiftMark Format — the format

An open specification (CC BY-SA 4.0) for writing workouts in markdown. Human-writable, machine-parseable, app-independent. This is the commons. (Formerly "LMWF".)

LiftMark — the app

The iOS app that reads LMWF: import, track sets in real time, see history, sync to Health, generate workouts with AI. This is the product.

Positioning

For lifters who'd rather train than fight their tracking app. LiftMark is the workout tracker built on open, portable plain text — so your programs are never locked in, and your AI of choice can write them for you.

Personality

Technical but athletic. Precise, unfussy, and quietly confident — the feel of a good command line meets the energy of a working gym. We sound like a strong training partner who happens to be an engineer: direct, encouraging, never preachy.

Open

No lock-in. The format belongs to everyone.

Fast

Plain text in, structured training out.

Strong

Built for the set in front of you.

Tagline

Your workouts, kept in plain text.

Alternates: "Write it, then lift it." · "Workouts that are just text." · "Your program, your file."

Naming

The primary brand is **lift.md** — the name is literally a markdown file, which says the whole premise in five characters. **LiftMark** is the formal, spoken name (and the App Store listing); “mark” does double duty for markdown and for a personal mark you hit. The open format is **LiftMark Format / lift.md format** (formerly “LMWF”). One identity carries all of them — the barbell # mark has no letters, so it fits every name.

How LiftMark talks

Warm, clear, and actually helpful — like a friend who knows their way around the gym. We explain things simply, cheer you on, and skip the hype.

We are

Friendly · clear · encouraging · helpful · down-to-earth.

We are not

Hype-y · salesy · jargon-heavy · cold · preachy.

In practice

Instead of

"🔥 CRUSH your goals with the ULTIMATE AI-powered fitness revolution!!"

Say

"Paste in a workout and start lifting — we'll keep track for you."

Instead of

"Our proprietary engine leverages synergistic data pipelines."

Say

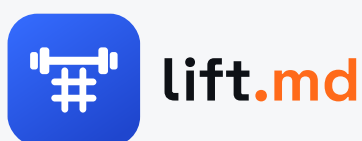
"Your workouts are just text — easy to read, and yours to keep."

When in doubt, write like you're helping a friend get started: clear, kind, and no longer than it needs to be.

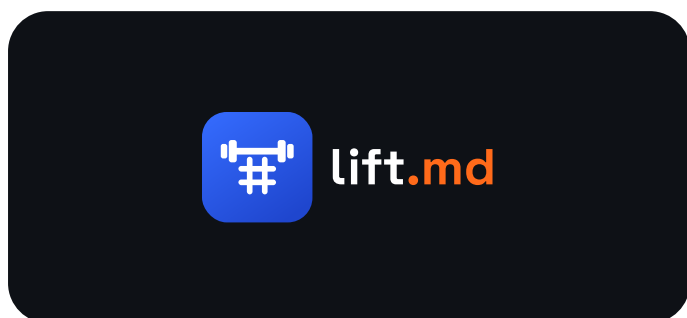
The barbell # mark

The mark fuses the two halves of the product into one symbol: a **#** (markdown — plain text) racked on a **barbell** (lifting), framed by the plates. It sits on a subtle blue-gradient tile. No letters, so it carries every name equally — and it's nothing like the boxed-monogram look it replaced.

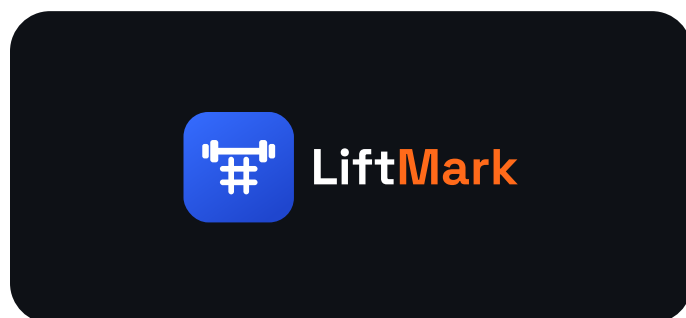
Primary lockup



Mark + wordmark on light backgrounds. Shown as `lift.md`, the primary brand.



Reversed — white wordmark on ink & photos.



Same mark, formal LiftMark wordmark.

Components



ICON — app tile



MARK — barbell # alone



FAVICON — the mark, scaled

The favicon is the primary mark itself, exported small — not a separate symbol. Keep it on the blue tile so it stays recognisable down to a browser tab.

Tile variants



BLUE — primary



INK — alt / dark



LIGHT — editorial

Subtle blue gradient on the tile for depth; the mark itself is solid white (or ink on light). Keep the barbell and # at the locked proportions — don't restyle the # or detach it from the bar.

One mark, one family

The barbell # and the type system carry every name. **lift.md** is the primary brand; a light **JetBrains Mono** descriptor after a thin divider sets each sub-brand — so the format reads as part of the family, not a separate logo.



lift.md primary brand · the app & domain



lift.md | format the open format, as the domain



LiftMark formal name (spoken / app stores)



LiftMark | Format the open format (formal · was “LMWF”)

Lead with **lift.md**. **LiftMark** is the spoken/formal name (and the App Store listing), and **LiftMark Format** / **lift.md format** name the spec. Set the descriptor in JetBrains Mono — never re-typeset it in the display face.

Give it room

Keep clear space around the logo equal to the height of the “L” in the wordmark (or one-quarter of the icon’s height). Nothing — type, edges, other logos — enters this zone.



Minimum sizes

Lockup

≥ 120 px / 32 mm wide (digital / print).

LM icon

≥ 24 px. Holds down to a favicon.

Glyph

Monogram alone for watch faces & badges.

Don't do this



Don't place on muddy / low-contrast colors.



Don't rotate, skew, or tilt the mark.



Don't stretch or distort proportions.

LiftMark

Don't recolor outside the palette.

LiftMark

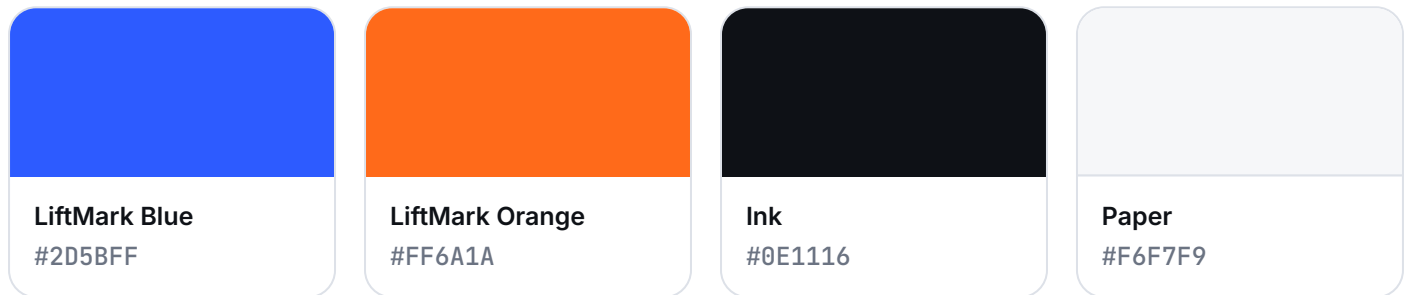
Don't re-typeset the wordmark in another font.



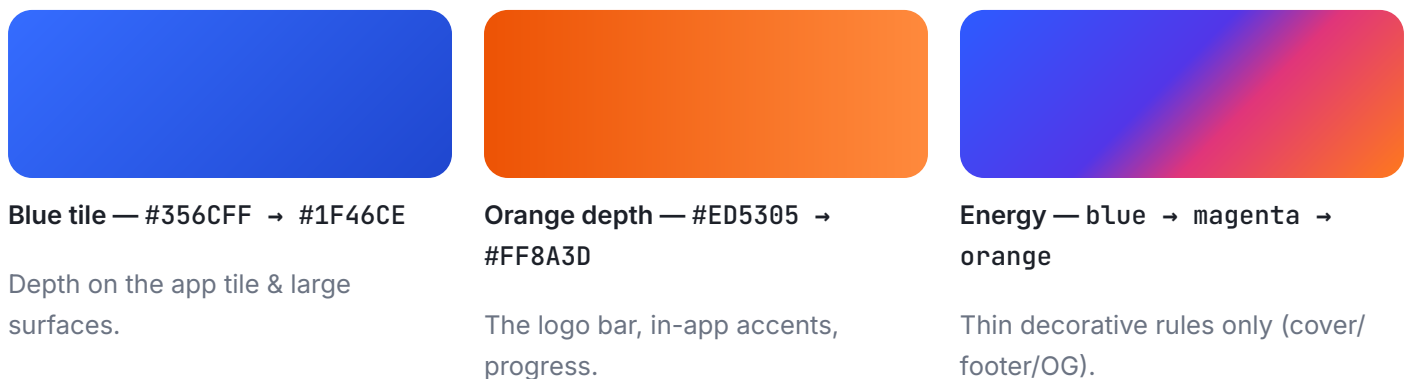
Don't add a drop shadow, bevel, or 3-D effect.

Two colors, two gradients

Blue carries trust and structure; orange carries energy and effort — discipline and output. Gradient is welcome, with one rule: **never blend the two hues together**. Each gradient lives inside a single colour, so nothing ever muddies into brown.



The brand gradients



The **Energy** gradient is the one place blue and orange may travel together — routed through magenta so it never browns. Reserve it for thin decorative bars; never put it behind text or use it as a tile/fill.

The one rule

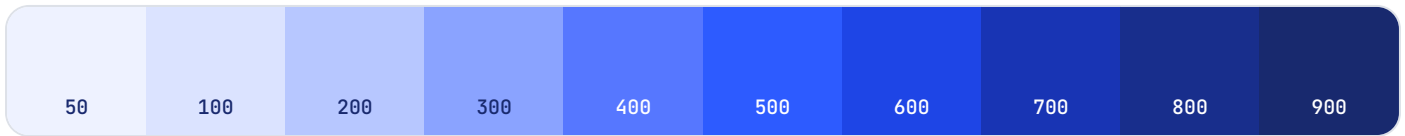
Never fade blue into orange — in a fill. A direct two-stop blue→orange blend runs through a muddy, brownish middle. So keep every surface gradient inside one hue (blue→blue, orange→orange), and let the two hues meet as hard, separate shapes — like the orange bar on the blue tile. The single exception is the thin **Energy** rule above: routed through magenta, it carries both colours without browning, and only ever as a decorative line.



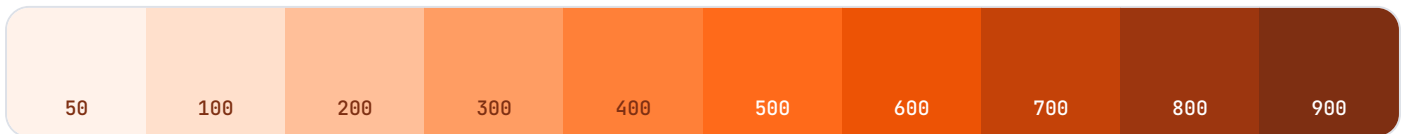
Tints & shades

Each ramp runs 50→900. 500 is the brand value. Use lighter steps for surfaces and states, darker for text and pressed states.

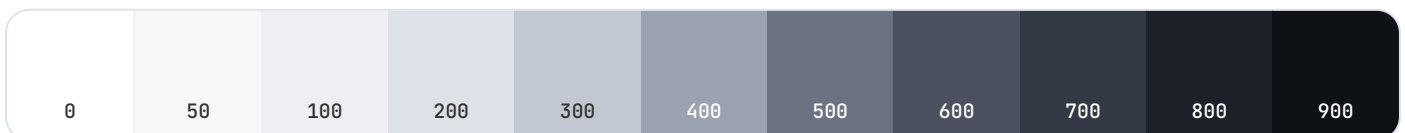
Blue



Orange



Neutral / Slate



Semantic



Light, dark, and legible

LiftMark ships light and dark (auto by default). Use the semantic roles — not raw hex — so surfaces flip cleanly. Tokens are in `liftmark-tokens.css` and `LiftMarkColors.swift`.

LIGHT

text #0E1116 · muted #6B7382 · link #1E45E6

DARK

text #F6F7F9 · muted #9AA2B0 · link #8AA3FF

Contrast — measured (WCAG 2.1)

Ink / White

18.9 : 1

AAA

Body text. Default everywhere.

White / Blue

5.2 : 1

AA

Primary buttons, white label OK.

Blue 600 / White

6.9 : 1

AA

Use Blue 600 for text links on light.

Ink / Orange

6.5 : 1

AA

Orange buttons need **dark** labels.

Orange / White

2.9 : 1

FAIL

Orange text/UI on white is decorative only.

Rule of thumb: **orange is a highlighter, blue is the pen**. Orange never carries body text or essential UI on a light surface — use ink or blue and let orange accent.

Three typefaces

All open-source (OFL) — fitting for an open project, and free to embed anywhere.

Aa

Space Grotesk

Display & headings. Geometric, a little technical.
Weights 500 / 700.

Aa

Inter

Body & UI. Quiet, dependable at small sizes.
400 / 500 / 600.

Aa

JetBrains Mono

Code & LMWF. The voice of the format itself. 500.

Type scale

Display • 700 • 49px

Track your
lifts

H1 • 700 • 39px

Track your
lifts

H2 • 700 • 31px

Track your
lifts

H3 • 500 • 25px

Track your
lifts

Body • Inter 400 • 16px

Paste a workout and start lifting.

Mono • JB Mono • 14px

- 225 x 5 @rest: 180s

Headings set tight: `letter-spacing: -0.02em`, line-height 1.1–1.2. Body breathes at 1.6.
Don't set body copy in Space Grotesk, and don't set headings in mono.

Icon style

Line icons on a 24×24 grid, 2 px stroke, rounded caps and joins. Match SF Symbols' weight so they sit naturally in iOS. Ink or muted slate by default; brand color only to signal state or action.



workout



rest timer



history



import



set done



tags



search

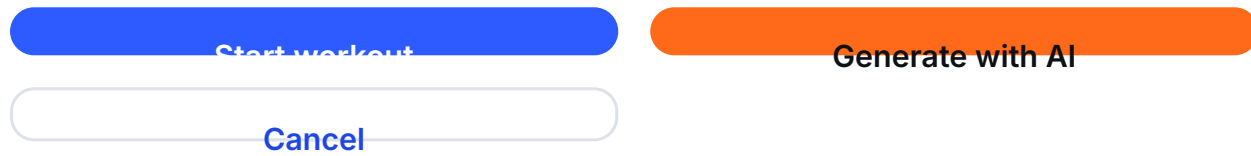


sync

Avoid filled, multicolor, or skeuomorphic icons. One concept per icon; if it needs a label to read, simplify the icon.

Putting it together

Buttons



Primary = solid blue, white label. Orange is the hero/accent action and always takes ink labels. Ghost for secondary. No gradient fills.

Radius & spacing

Radius

sm 8 · md 12 · lg 16 · xl 24 · pill 999. App tile = 22.46% of edge.

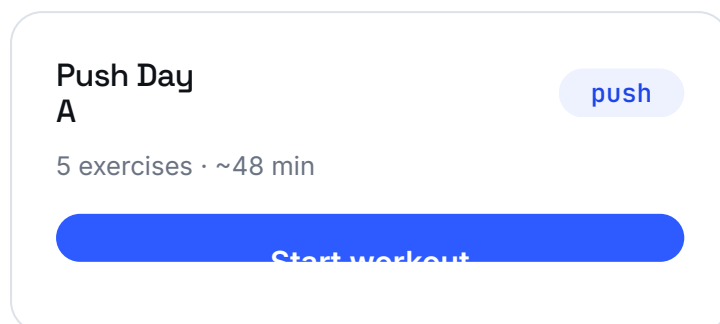
Spacing

8-pt base: 4 · 8 · 12 · 16 · 24 · 32 · 48 · 64.

Elevation

Soft, low shadows. Cards rest on Paper, not float.

Card example



Markdown is the look

The LMWF syntax is a brand asset. When we show a workout, we style it consistently: ink background, mono type, headings muted, **@modifiers** in orange, set lines in light blue.

```
# Push Day @tags: strength, push @units: lbs ## Bench Press - 135 x 5 @rest:
120s - 185 x 5 @rest: 180s - 225 x 5 @rest: 180s Aim for RPE 7
```

Use the `#` heading mark as a recurring graphic motif — in taglines (“# Workouts in plain text.”), section titles, and social. It signals “this is plain text” at a glance.

Out in the world

Open Graph / share card



1200×630. Ink field, centered lockup, a real LiftMark Format snippet, orange-depth foot bar. `og-liftmark` and `og-liftmd` templates in `assets/social/`.

App icon



Blue-gradient tile, white barbell #. Ink and light are alternates; the favicon is the same mark, just scaled. PNG exports (1024/512/180/120), favicons (48/32/24/16), and the square App Store icon live in `assets/icons/` (`lm-*`).

Build from the source

Everything in this book is shipped as code. Pull these into the Astro site and the iOS app so design and product never drift.

```
assets/tokens/liftmark-tokens.css — CSS custom properties, light + dark
assets/tokens/liftmark-tokens.json — framework-agnostic design tokens
assets/tokens/LiftMarkColors.swift — SwiftUI Color tokens (light + dark)
assets/fonts/ — Space Grotesk · Inter · JetBrains Mono (woff2 + ttf)
assets/logos/ — LM icon · wordmarks · lockups · glyph (SVG)
assets/icons/ — app icons, favicons & square App Store icon (PNG, lm-*)
assets/social/ — OG templates: og-liftmark, og-liftmd (SVG + PNG)
```

Quick start (web): `@import "assets/tokens/liftmark-tokens.css";` then use `var(--lm-accent)`, `var(--lm-text)`, `var(--lm-orange)`. iOS: drop in `LiftMarkColors.swift` and use `Color.lmAccent` / `Color.lmOrange`. Gradients: keep each inside one hue (blue→blue, orange→orange) — never blend blue into orange.

LiftMark Brand Book · v3.0

App code: MPL-2.0 · LiftMark Format spec: CC BY-SA 4.0 · Fonts: SIL OFL

[liftmark.app](#) · github.com/vfilby/liftmark